

Earthy = Marsy

Earthy = Venusy

But, for reasons we have already discussed — namely, the fact that identity is transitive — these three claims do not sit well together. So it appears that the psychological theory implies a contradiction.

Marsy $\neq$ Venusy



Basically the same point could be made about the version of the story on which, after the transmission to Mars, the individual who steps into the teletransporter on Earth steps back out. To tell that version of the story, we'd just need to introduce two names — Earthy-1 and Earthy-2 — for the individual on earth pre-teletransportation, and the individual who exists after the teletransportation.

It is easy enough to turn this into an argument against the psychological theory of survival.

1. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Marsy.
 2. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Venusy.
 3. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Marsy = Venusy. (1,2)
 4. Marsy $\neq$ Venusy.
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C. The psychological theory of survival is false.
(3,4)

These cases look bad for the psychological theory of survival. One might think that they provide a reason to favor a materialist view. What would a materialist say about teletransportation?

THE TELETRANSPORTATION ARGUMENT

This kind of example is called a case of **fission**, because (on the psychological view of survival) it looks like a case in which one person becomes two people.

At a first glance, this looks problematic only for the psychological view of survival.
But, as it turns out, cases of fission can be used to make trouble for other theories
of survival as well.

Let's return to a case we discussed earlier: the example of the Brain Transplant.

“Suppose first that I am one of a pair of identical twins, and that both my body and my twin’s brain have been fatally injured. Because of advances in neuro-surgery, it is not inevitable that these injuries will cause us both to die. We have between us one healthy brain and one healthy body. Surgeons can put these together.

If all of my brain continues both to exist and to be the brain of one living person, who is psychologically continuous with me, I continue to exist. This is true whatever happens to the rest of my body. ...”

As Parfit points out, we can also imagine a case in which only one hemisphere of
your brain survives.

“It is in fact true that one hemisphere is enough. There are many people who have survived, when a stroke or injury puts out of action one of their hemispheres. With his remaining hemisphere, such a person may need to re-learn certain things, such as adult speech, or how to control both hands. But this is possible. ... [So] I would survive if my brain was successfully transplanted into my twin's body. And I could survive with only half my brain, the other half having been destroyed. Given these two facts, it seems clear that I would survive if half my brain was successfully transplanted into my twin's body, and the other half was destroyed.”

Let's call this the **Transplant**.

Could you survive Hemisphere Transplant? As Parfit says, we can imagine that there would be more or less complete psychological continuity before and after the surgery. So on the psychological theory of survival, it seems clear that you would survive.

What should the proponent of soul survival say? Unlike the psychological theorist, the soul theorist is not forced into an answer here. But the fact of psychological continuity would seem to make the view that one can survive attractive.

What should the proponent of a materialist theory say? We saw that the case of Brain Transplant was reason for the materialist to say that survival requires the survival of a brain rather than a whole organism. Just so, perhaps the case of Hemisphere Transplant suggests that survival only requires the survival of one hemisphere of the brain.

So, it is plausible that the proponent of any of our views of survival should be inclined to think that one can survive Hemisphere Transplant.

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